

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

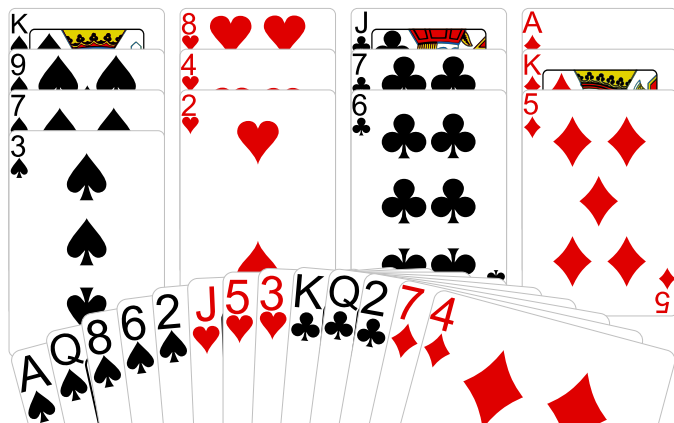
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

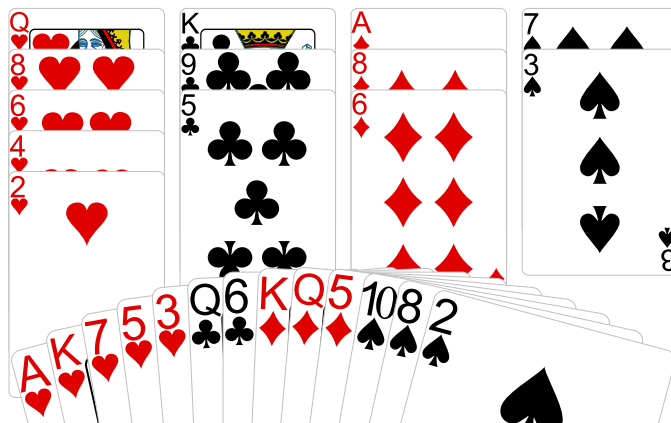
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 3♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



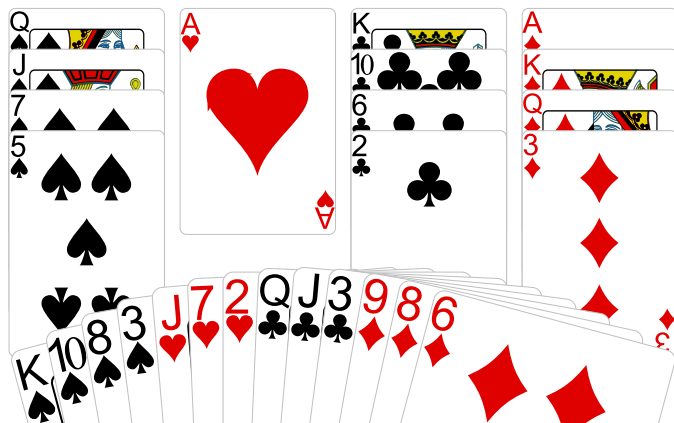
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



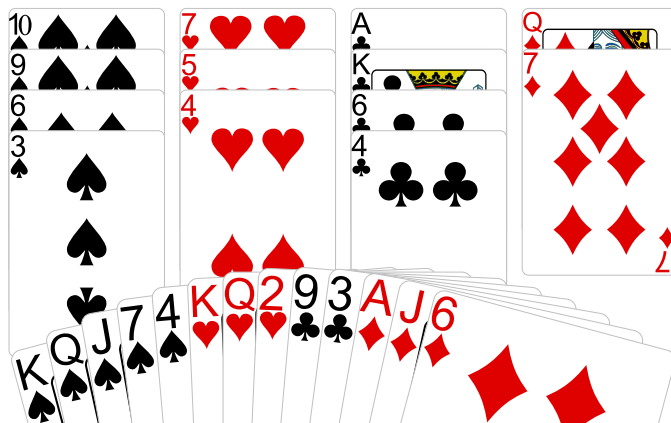
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: West

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ J T 5
♥ K T 7 6
♦ Q J 3
♣ T 4 3

12
7 10
11

♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2



♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6

♠ 4
♥ A Q 9
♦ T 9 8 6 2
♣ A 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
All Pass			
3 ♠ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 17

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding.

But when NORTH opens 1 ♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength"

by jumping to 3 ♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5

10
9 14
7

♠ A K Q J 9 6 4

♥ -

♦ 3 2

♣ T 8 4 2

N
W E
S

♠ 5

♥ J T 9

♦ J T 9 7 4

♣ A J 7 3

♠ T 8 2

♥ A K 7 5 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 6

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 18

After EAST opens with 1

♥

, WEST has a small "dilemma".

With 11 points she really is only strong enough
to make a jump raise to 3

♥

.

But, with five trumps the hand deserves more.
So she just bids 4

♥

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by East

instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens

with you should just jump right to game.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 6 4
♥ Q T 8 3
♦ T 4 2
♣ 7 5

19
6 8
7

♠ Q J 7 5
♥ A
♦ A K Q 3
♣ K T 6 2



♠ K T 8 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ Q J 3

♠ 2
♥ K 9 6 5 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ A 9 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game.

She bids 4 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 19

NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start

with 1

♦

.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit

so he responds 1 ♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 7 4
 ♥ K Q 2
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ 9 3

7
 16 9
 8

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A T 6 3

♦ K 8 3 2

♣ 8 7



♠ A

♥ J 9 8

♦ T 9 5 4

♣ Q J T 5 2

♠ T 9 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ Q 7

♣ A K 6 4

West

1 ♠

3 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

2 ♠

4 ♠

South

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 20

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

WEST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1 ♠ rather than 1NT.

EAST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2 ♠.

WEST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3 ♠.

EAST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4 ♠.